THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

MONDAY, OCTOBER 19, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

"I will give one of my SpaceX shares to every kid in America"

Elon Musk answered Anthropic's new public benefit fund with a pledge of his own before dawn Monday: one SpaceX share for every American child next year, "the first of many." At Friday's close that is about $10.5 billion, CNBC calculated. Hours later Tesla filed a proxy asking shareholders to re-elect him to its board on December 3.

SpaceX reports quarterly results Tuesday and Tesla on Wednesday. Over the weekend Musk traded a Monty Python insult with AI scientist Yann LeCun over the flying Roadster, urged Texans to vote as early voting opened in the Senate race he is funding, and watched Washington and Kyiv argue over who capped Ukraine's Starshield service.

I · TESLA

A board vote, and the Roadster's critics

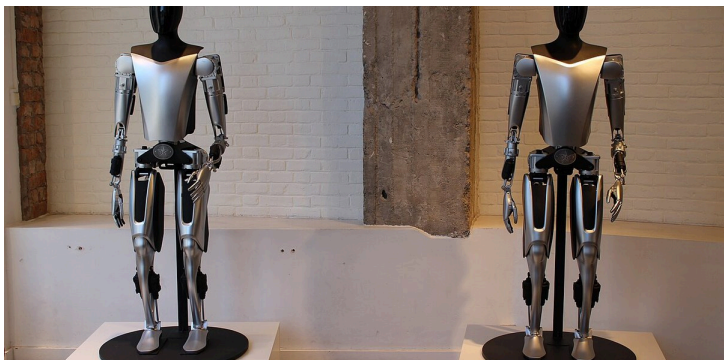
"Optimus and Cybercab will be the vast majority of Tesla's value," Musk wrote on Sunday.

Dec 3
annual meeting; Musk, Denholm and Straubel up for re-election

~400 mph
peak Roadster speed Musk says Tesla can reach

Oct 21
third-quarter results, webcast 5:30 p.m. EDT

Tesla's proxy asks shareholders to re-elect Musk, chair Robyn Denholm and JB Straubel to three-year terms, approve 2025 pay in an advisory vote and ratify the auditor at a meeting at Gigafactory Texas and online, Reuters reported. It includes no merger proposal (DEF 14A), though prediction-market odds of a Tesla-SpaceX combination before March jumped to 56% on Friday, CNBC reported.



Two Tesla Optimus humanoid robots on display in Stockholm on May 13, 2024.
PHOTO: ULF KLINGSTRÖM / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Yann LeCun calculated that compressed air gives the Roadster about five seconds of useful thrust and called it a "cute demo, but totally impractical," EVXL reported. "I fart in your general direction," Musk replied. He kept promising: "I think we can reach a peak speed of >0.5 Mach or ~400 mph" (post), and future demos may include "flying over the Snake River or maybe Grand Canyon" (post). "Since fate maximizes for ironic entertainment, it was inevitable that the 'Roadster' would be a flying car," he wrote. He also announced that Slovakia had approved FSD (Supervised).

II · SPACEX, GROK & X

"Giving the shares directly to the public"

A reply to Anthropic became a pledge; SpaceXAI faced City Hall; X got an ad dress code.

Anthropic said Sunday it will put 5% of its shares into a public benefit fund (Anthropic). "I recommend giving the shares directly to the public," Musk replied, and "This is what I will be doing." At 3:52 a.m. EDT Monday he posted the pledge. He did not say how shares would reach the roughly 72 million U.S. children, CNBC noted. SpaceX's third-quarter results come Tuesday after the close, with a webcast at 4:30 p.m. EDT (SpaceX).



The launch tower's arms catch a Super Heavy booster at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024. SpaceX aims to catch both booster and ship on Flight 15.

PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

At a New York City Council hearing Friday, Speaker Julie Menin told a SpaceXAI manager she had produced a sexualized image of herself with Grok that morning, and called the company's testimony "simply unacceptable" (NYC Council). On X, Musk declared that "advertisers who post ads that are ugly, shrill, strident or overstate claims about their product will be barred from advertising," and that "our team makes around around 20 improvements per day to Grok @Bot."

He also said "Grok @Bot got much faster," posted "Hire Grok @Bot today," and wrote that X "is seeing all-time high usage." To a post putting SpaceX's addressable market at $28.5 trillion, he replied, "We were wrong. It is vastly higher than that." Of renting AI capacity from cloud providers so SpaceX can "shift load off our training clusters," he said a post mocking the process "describes the conversation SpaceX has had."

III · POLITICS & UKRAINE

"Control of the senate will decide the future of America"

Texas began early voting; Kyiv and Washington traded charges over satellite limits.

Early voting in Texas opened Monday and runs through October 30 in the Senate race between Republican Ken Paxton and Democrat James Talarico, CBS Texas reported. Musk, whose $158 million went to a PAC backing Paxton, wrote that "control of the senate will decide the future of America" and posted "Talarico hates Texas." Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Sunday he believed the U.S. government was behind speed limits on Starshield; Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said he "should be very careful about making statements like this that aren't true," CNBC reported.

Musk wrote last week that "any limits on speed or usage are decided by the US military and ultimately POTUS," and President Trump has said, "it wasn't me, and I don't think it was Elon," CNBC noted. Of Texas early voting he posted one word: "Important."

On the record

Two earnings calls this week, and a shareholder meeting set for December.

Coming up

Tuesday, October 20, 4:30 p.m. EDT: SpaceX's audio-only third-quarter webcast, also streamed on X (SpaceX). Wednesday, October 21, 5:30 p.m. EDT: Tesla's third-quarter webcast (8-K). Thursday, December 3, 4:00 p.m. EST: Tesla's annual meeting, at Gigafactory Texas and online (proxy).

Looking back October 16–19, 2026

Musk said in an interview that the Raptor Vacuum shutdown on Starship's last flight was a software "glitch" isolated to one engine computer, and that Flight 15 should launch before Thanksgiving with catches of both booster and ship, NASASpaceflight reported. On X he wrote that "so many people are going to get one-shotted by super persuasive super intelligences and I might be one of them."

Takeaways

1. **Musk pledged one SpaceX share to every U.S. child next year.**
2. **Tesla's December 3 proxy seeks his re-election; there is no merger item.**
3. **SpaceX reports Tuesday, Tesla Wednesday.**
4. **Musk answered LeCun's Roadster physics with a Monty Python line.**
5. **Kyiv blamed Washington for Starshield limits; Bessent pushed back.**

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk.

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